

Parent Guide — primary / module-02- panchabhuta

IKS Curriculum

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Parent Guide — Module 2: The Five Friends (Panchabhūta)

Your child's age: Primary (Grades 3–5) · **Module length:** 10 sessions × 30 min over ~2 weeks

What your child is learning

The *pañca-mahābhūta* — five Sanskrit names for everyday things: - **Pṛthvī** (earth) — solid things - **Ap** (water) — liquid things - **Tejas** (fire) — warmth, light - **Vāyu** (air) — wind, breath - **Ākāśa** (space) — empty room

This is a 2000+ year old framework from Indian philosophy for organising the everyday world. We teach it alongside what your child knows from school science (solid, liquid, gas) — not instead of it.

What to expect this fortnight

A daily chant. Your child will come home singing: > *Pṛthvī, ap, tejas, vāyu, ākāśa* > Earth, water, fire, air, space!

That repetition is the whole point. By Day 5 your child should remember all five.

Homework you'll see: - Bring 3 small objects from home (Day 1). - Find one thing that's "all five qualities" (Day 2 — e.g. soil, jaggery). - A 20-min walk to find a place where one element is "too much" or "missing" (Day 7 — pollution, etc.). - A drawing / model / 30-second story project (Days 8–10).

Day 10 = "Show + Tell." Your child will stand up and show their project for 30 seconds. They get a sticker.

How to help — and how NOT to help

Helpful: - Ask "which of the five friends did you meet today?" at dinner. - For the home walk, accompany your child — Grade 3–4 students shouldn't walk alone. - For their project: provide materials (paper, crayons, recycled items) and let *them* decide what to make. - Sing the chant with them. Repetition embeds.

Not helpful: - Quizzing them on Sanskrit pronunciation. Approximate is fine. - Doing the project for them. A wobbly drawing they did themselves beats a perfect one you made. - Worrying about “are they doing it right?” — at this age the goal is *noticing*, not getting answers correct.

Common questions

- **“Why Sanskrit?”** Because the framework comes from a tradition that used Sanskrit. We give the English meaning every time. It’s no different from learning that “H₂O” is water — a label that opens a door to a body of knowledge.
- **“Is this religious?”** No — we teach it as Indian intellectual tradition (the framework comes from Sāṅkhya philosophy). Devotional aspects are honoured but not centred.
- **“Will this be tested?”** Not with a paper quiz at this age. Oral recall + a sticker for the Day 10 show-and-tell.

What success looks like

By the end of the module, your child can: - Name all five elements in Sanskrit and English. - Point to one example of each in your home. - Tell you, in their own words, a story about one of them.

That’s it. Anything beyond this is a bonus.

Want to go deeper?

If your child wants to know more, the Middle-band (Grade 6–8) version of this module covers the same topic in much more depth — including how each element pairs with a “quality” (sound, touch, sight, taste, smell). You can preview it at [curriculum/middle/module-02-panchabhuta/README.md](#) in the project folder.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 2 (Primary) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

At a glance (35-min sessions)

Day	Title	Activity	Output
1	Five Friends Story	Story + meet sample objects	Drawing of one element
2	Earth and Water	Touch + sort	Drawing
3	Fire and Air	Feel warmth + blow on hand	Drawing
4	Space — the Quiet Friend	Notice the gap	Drawing
5	Five-Element Song	Sing the names	Recall check
6	Sort It	Big sorting activity	Group portrait of trays

Day	Title	Activity	Output
7	Find an Imbalance	Walk + draw	Map drawing
8	Project Day 1	Start your element project	Project draft
9	Project Day 2	Finish + practise telling	Project ready
10	Show + Tell	Each child shows for 30 sec	Final project + sticker

Daily structure (35 min)

Time	What
5 min	Settle + the daily chant (the five names)
10 min	Story or new content
15 min	Hands-on / drawing
5 min	Show what you made (1–2 children)

The daily chant

Same chorus every day:

pr̥thvī, ap, tejas, vāyu, ākāśa Earth, water, fire, air, space!

Say it 3 times — soft, normal, loud. Add a clap on each name.

Pacing notes

- 35 minutes is short — protect it. Don’t let the story creep into the activity time.
- The hands-on time is the most important. Drawing IS the learning at this band.
- Skip Day 5 if your class is moving fast; the song can be a warm-up on other days.

What children leave with

- The five names sung as a chant.
- One drawing per element in their drawing folder.
- One project they can show to a younger sibling.
- The habit of asking “what kind of thing is this?” when they look at an object.